

EMPOWERING WOMEN, ENRICHING ENUGU: Validation of WEE Policy Paves Way for Gender Equality



Stakeholders

Enugu State has taken a significant step towards promoting gender equality and women's economic empowerment with the successful validation of the Enugu State Women's Economic Empowerment (WEE) Policy. The policy, developed by the South Saharan Social Development Organisation with support from the development Research and Projects Centre (dRPC) and in collaboration with the Enugu State Ministry of Children, Gender Affairs and Social Development, is designed to break down barriers that hinder women's access to economic opportunities, promoting their empowerment in critical areas like employment, entrepreneurship, and leadership. This policy also seeks to boost women's economic participation by improving their access to education, healthcare, and addressing the legal and cultural obstacles that limit their economic empowerment.

A key aspect of the policy's development was the validation process, which brought together stakeholders from government ministries, civil society organizations, and the private sector to provide feedback and ensure broad-based support. This collaborative approach enabled stakeholders to share their expertise and insights, ensuring that the policy remains practical and actionable. The

policy's objectives are equally well-aligned with the state's economic and social priorities, ensuring that women's empowerment is integrated into the state's overall development strategy.



Breakout Sessions

The Enugu State Commissioner for Children, Gender Affairs, and Social Development, Mrs. Ngozi Enih, delivered an inspiring speech at the validation workshop, highlighting the vital role women's economic empowerment plays in achieving sustainable development and reducing poverty. She emphasized that empowering women economically is crucial for the state's growth, as it enables them to contribute fully to the economy and improve their livelihood.



Mrs. Ngozi Enih, Enugu State Commissioner for Children, Gender Affairs, and Social Development

Dr. Stanley Illechukwu, Executive Director of the South Saharan Social Development Organization (SSDO), noted that the WEE Policy is aligned with the core objectives of SSDO of making development happen for women. He reiterated that the Policy seeks to address the unique challenges faced by women in Enugu State, and that it will focus on promoting women's economic participation by improving their access to education, healthcare, and financial resources. This will enable women to participate fully in the economy as entrepreneurs, employees, or consumers. Additionally, the policy aims to address legal and cultural barriers that limit women's economic empowerment, creating an environment where women can thrive economically.



Dr. Stanley Illechukwu, Executive Director, SSDO

With the successful validation of the Women's Economic Empowerment (WEE) Policy, Enugu State is poised to make giant strides in promoting gender equality and empowering women economically. This landmark policy is expected to have a profound impact on the lives of women in the state, enabling them to participate fully in the economy and contribute to the state's sustainable development.

The state's determination to create a level playing field for women is a testament to its vision for a more inclusive and equitable society. As the implementation of the policy gets underway, the people of Enugu State can look forward to a brighter future for women and girls.